

GRIEVANCE OUTCOME

CONFIDENTIAL · REF GR-GRV-2026-014 · 18 FEBRUARY
2026

OFFICE OF THE HR DIRECTOR | PEOPLE & CULTURE | GRANTHORNE HOUSE

Our ref: GR-GRV-2026-014 · Your grievance dated 14 January 2026

Ms Leah Miller
18 Ridgeway Crescent
Sale
Manchester
M33 6XJ

Strictly Private & Confidential · Sent by Royal Mail Signed For (tracking RM 4127 9088 6GB) and by email

Re: Grievance dated 14 January 2026, outcome

Dear Leah,

Thank you for raising your formal grievance dated 14 January 2026. I write to confirm that the investigation has now concluded.

Investigation process

The investigation was led by Mr Iain Robertshaw, Group Operations Director, who is independent of Mr Morley's direct line of report. Mr Robertshaw was supported by Ms Sarah Brentwood, HR Business Partner. The investigation comprised:

(a) an initial interview with you on 22 January 2026, in which we took you through each of the five examples and supporting points (a) to (e) set out in your letter; (b) an interview with Mr Daniel Morley on 28 January 2026; (c) interviews with the seven other attendees at the 12 December 2024 Leadership meeting and with two of the colleagues you named as having witnessed the immediate aftermath of the 4 March 2025 conversation (Ms Priya Mehta and Mr Tomasz Bednarski), between 29 January and 5 February 2026; (d) a review of the documentary record, comprising your notebook extracts, the meeting calendars and Teams transcripts for the dates you cited, the promotion files for the Senior Operations Manager (Feb 2024) and Head of Strategic Operations (Nov 2025) competitions, your performance appraisals for 2024 and 2025, your two GP fit notes (5 March and 24 to 28 March 2025) and the Health Assured EAP referral confirmation (ref. HA-25-118332).

Findings, strand 1, bullying and undermining behaviour

Having considered the evidence in the round, the investigator was not satisfied that the conduct described amounts to bullying within the meaning of the Company's Dignity at Work policy. The investigator addressed each of the five points you raised as follows:

Point (a), 12 December 2024 Leadership meeting ("frankly amateur"): the investigator accepts that the phrase was used. Four of the seven attendees confirmed it; two did not recall it; one (Mr Morley) recalled the substance but not the exact words. The investigator concluded that, in context, the comment fell within the bounds of robust feedback in a senior operational forum and did not, on its own or with the other points, cross into bullying. He notes that the contingency plan was subsequently adopted and delivered against target.

Point (b), 4 March 2025 (shouting incident): the investigator accepts that the exchange was elevated and that you left the meeting upset. Mr Morley acknowledges he "raised his voice" and "banged the desk once", and has expressed regret. The investigator views this as a one-off lapse rather than a sustained course of conduct, and Mr Morley has been given a formal management note (held on his personal file) about the standard of conduct expected in one-to-one meetings.

Point (c), exclusion from South network decisions: the investigator examined the three specific instances you cited (Avonmouth route consolidation on 11 February 2025, the Q2 reforecast call with Mr Heaney on 8 May 2025, and the Halterley SLA waiver of 17 September 2025). In each case Mr Morley has explained that the decision was time-bounded and had to be made before you were next due in the office; in the Halterley case he relies on a verbal authorisation he says you gave on 15 September which you dispute. The investigator was unable to resolve the factual dispute on the Halterley point on the balance of probabilities, and on the other two points accepted Mr Morley's rationale as a legitimate, if imperfect, exercise of operational discretion.

Point (d), questioning of competence in front of junior staff: the investigator was satisfied that the comment on 13 August 2025 at the Reading driver brief was inappropriate in the way it was delivered and has separately raised this with Mr Morley. The other three occasions (17 April, 2 June, 22 October 2025) were, in the investigator's view, capable of being read as managerial criticism rather than personal denigration, and accordingly did not amount to bullying within the meaning of the policy.

Point (e), impact on wellbeing: the investigator notes the two fit notes, the GP-confirmed work-related stress and the EAP referral, and is sympathetic. He notes that under our Dignity at Work policy impact alone is not determinative of the bullying question; the relevant test is whether the conduct objectively amounts to bullying, which on his findings above it does not.

Taken in the round, the investigator's conclusion is that the exchanges between you and Mr Morley have, on a number of occasions, been robust and on one occasion (4 March 2025) regrettably elevated, but that this does not fall outside the bounds of legitimate management feedback in a high-pressure operational environment to the extent required by the policy.

Findings, strand 2, promotion decisions

In relation to the two promotion decisions (Senior Operations Manager, February 2024, and Head of Strategic Operations, November 2025), the investigator reviewed the panel scoring sheets, the job specifications, the long-list to short-list rationale, and the recorded panel notes. He concluded that the appointments of Mr Sam Heaney and Mr Ross Hopkin were made on the basis of the Company's standard selection process and the recorded panel scores. He was not provided with material that, in his assessment,

evidenced less favourable treatment on the grounds of sex, and he notes that the panels for both competitions were mixed in gender composition.

Outcome: the grievance is not upheld on either strand.

Recommendations and undertakings

The investigator has, however, made the following recommendations which the Company accepts and will implement:

(a) a structured monthly one-to-one cadence between you and Mr Morley, with written agendas and notes shared in advance, to commence with effect from 1 March 2026; (b) Mr Morley to attend the Company's "Conduct in Difficult Conversations" module via Health Assured, by 31 March 2026; (c) for all internal promotion decisions going forward, a written rationale will be shared with unsuccessful internal candidates on request; (d) HR will check in with you at 4-week intervals over the next three months to monitor the working relationship and your wellbeing.

Programme "Compass" — separate workstream

For transparency, and to address any question of overlap with the wider Operations Restructure:

As you are aware from the Operations Leadership cascade of **04 February 2026**, the Company is in the early stages of implementing Programme "Compass", the wider restructure of the Network Operations function. Compass was approved in principle by the Board at its meeting on **28 January 2026**, and the detailed programme was confirmed at the Board's meeting of **11 February 2026**.

The conduct of your grievance under reference GR-GRV-2026-014 has been managed by the writer and the investigator (Mr Robertshaw) independently of Compass, and the outcome above has been reached on the merits of the grievance and not by reference to Compass or to any role-by-role consequences that may flow from it. Any next steps under Compass that affect you will be communicated to you separately by the Company in writing in due course.

Your right to appeal

If you do not accept this outcome, you have the right to appeal in writing within seven (7) calendar days of the date of this letter. Your appeal should set out the grounds on which you wish to appeal and should be addressed to me, marked "Strictly Private and Confidential". The appeal hearing will be chaired by a member of the Executive who has not been involved in the matter to date.

I appreciate this will not be the outcome you were hoping for, and you should not hesitate to contact me or Sarah Brentwood directly if there is anything else we can do to support you in the meantime.

Kind regards,

K Westwood

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cc: Mr Iain Robertshaw, Group Operations Director (investigator) · Ms Sarah Brentwood, HR Business Partner · Personal HR file